Building Health Checklist

A periodic audit checklist to track a structure's condition over time — EDITABLE VERSION

Property / Site:			
Auditor:		**Date:**	
Audit Interval:			
Previous Audit Date:		**Audit #:**	

A single inspection tells you the condition of a building today. Repeating the same checklist on a fixed schedule tells you the direction it's heading — which is what actually lets you plan capital repairs before they become emergencies. Use this checklist at consistent intervals (annually is typical) and compare each round against the last.

Rating Scale

Good	No deficiencies; performing as expected for age
Fair	Minor wear or early-stage deficiency; monitor at next audit
Poor	Clear deficiency; plan repair before next scheduled audit
Critical	Safety concern or active failure; address immediately

Rate every item Good / Fair / Poor / Critical. For anything rated Poor or Critical, note details and compare against the previous audit's rating for the same item.

1. Structural Systems

ITEM	Good	Fair	Poor	Critical	NOTES
Foundation walls free of new cracking since last audit	☐	☐	☐	☐	
No new settlement or differential movement observed	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Structural framing (beams, joists, columns) free of sagging, rot, or corrosion	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Load-bearing elements consistent with baseline photos/measurements	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Expansion joints and structural movement joints functioning as designed	☐	☐	☐	☐	

2. Building Envelope

ITEM	Good	Fair	Poor	Critical	NOTES
Roof covering condition consistent with expected remaining service life	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Roof flashing and penetrations intact, no new deterioration	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Exterior wall cladding/siding free of new cracks, displacement, or moisture staining	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Windows and doors sealing properly, no new drafts, fogging, or leaks	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Below-grade waterproofing/damp-proofing intact where visible	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Sealant and caulking joints intact at all envelope transitions	☐	☐	☐	☐	

3. Plumbing & Mechanical

ITEM	Good	Fair	Poor	Critical	NOTES
No new leaks, corrosion, or staining at visible plumbing lines	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Water heater and major equipment within expected remaining service life	☐	☐	☐	☐	
HVAC system operating within normal parameters; filters and maintenance current	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Sump pump / drainage systems tested and functional	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Backflow preventers and shutoff valves accessible and operable	☐	☐	☐	☐	

4. Electrical & Life Safety

ITEM	Good	Fair	Poor	Critical	NOTES
Electrical panel free of new corrosion, overheating signs, or code deficiencies	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Smoke and CO detectors present, tested, and within manufacturer service life	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Fire extinguishers charged, accessible, and inspection tags current	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Emergency lighting and exit signage functional	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Fire/life-safety systems (sprinklers, alarms) last serviced within required interval	☐	☐	☐	☐	

5. Interior Condition

ITEM	Good	Fair	Poor	Critical	NOTES
Flooring, walls, and ceilings free of new cracking, staining, or settlement signs	☐	☐	☐	☐	
No new signs of moisture intrusion, mold, or musty odor	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Doors and windows operating smoothly, no new sticking or misalignment	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Common areas and finishes consistent with baseline condition photos	☐	☐	☐	☐	

6. Site & Grounds

ITEM	Good	Fair	Poor	Critical	NOTES
Grading and drainage continue to direct water away from the structure	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Pavement, walkways, and curbs free of new heaving, settling, or cracking	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Trees and vegetation not encroaching on structure, roofline, or utilities	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Site lighting and exterior signage functional	☐	☐	☐	☐	

7. Condition Trend Log

Record the overall rating (G / F / P / C) for each system at every audit. Tracking this over multiple audits reveals which systems are declining faster than expected, even when no single audit looks alarming.

Building System	Audit 1 Date:	Audit 2 Date:	Audit 3 Date:	Audit 4 Date:
Structural Systems				
Building Envelope				
Plumbing & Mechanical				
Electrical & Life Safety				
Interior Condition				
Site & Grounds				

Tip: photograph the same reference points at every audit (same angle, same distance) so visual comparison across cycles is reliable, not just memory-based.

8. Priority Action Items From This Audit

#	Item	Rating	Target Date	Owner
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

Before closing this audit: compare every Poor or Critical rating against the same item's rating last cycle. An item that moved from Good to Poor in one cycle deserves more urgency than one that has been a stable Fair for years.

Auditor Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

This checklist is a general field aid for tracking building condition over time and does not replace periodic evaluation by a licensed structural engineer, building inspector, or relevant trade professional.